

NE.5 Forms & Documents Index

Every document you will meet, named as the agency names it — and the paper Nebraska never asks you for.

Before you use this document

This is a process reference, not legal advice. Nebraska adopts one state building code and then makes enforcing it optional: the code is "the legally applicable code regardless of whether the county, city, or village has provided for the administration or enforcement" of it, no county or city has to issue a building permit, and no state agency may inspect a private house. What does not depend on any of that: the **state electrical inspection**, enforced at the power meter; the **energy code**, which you build to yourself; and the **septic and well filings**, which are made by the professional or by you. Confirm every item with the office that will actually handle your parcel before you rely on it. Form names and fees were read from the agencies' own current forms in September 2026. Where no form exists, this document says so rather than inventing one.

THE STATE DOCUMENTS

What the state issues or requires, and what it costs

Document	What it is	Fee
Request for State Electrical Inspection with Homeowner Verification	The Division's name for the homeowner permit. Filed "at or before commencement" of wiring, online since April 13, 2026 (homeowner permits are linked by Division staff after you register) or on the paper Application for State Electrical Inspection , rev. 3-27-26. You sign the verification that you know the NEC and the Act	\$75 new service to 400 A + \$10 per circuit; homeowner minimum \$100; late \$250
Certificate to the electrical utility	Your statement to the power supplier "that inspection has been requested and that the conditions of the installation are safe for energization" (§ 81-2129). No state form ; the Division forwards a copy of the new-service permit to the supplier, and the utility has its own paper. Ask the utility what it wants	None
Approval notice	Optional written approval of the final electrical inspection. The one third-party record of the wiring your house will ever have; buy it	\$6
Onsite wastewater general-permit certification and system registration	In DWEE's Title 124 booklet (form 23-017). The certified professional, engineer or environmental health specialist signs the certification, attaches the scaled drawing and the perc data, and registers the system within 45 days of completion. You receive a copy	\$140; late \$150 (46-90 days), \$450 (91+)

What the state issues or requires, and what it costs

Document	What it is	Fee
Application for Permit (onsite wastewater)	The individual construction and operating permit for a system the general permit does not cover — plans "prepared and properly stamped and signed by a Professional Engineer"	\$450
Water well registration	DWEE's registration form, with the well-log information, within 60 days of completion — by the licensed driller, or by you if you drilled it	\$200 + \$25-\$40
Well log	Kept by "any owner of a water well or a licensed water well contractor" — eighteen listed items (§ 46-1241). Not a form you file; a record you keep	None
Water well variance request	Written, "at least 10 days prior" to construction, with a scaled map showing property lines, structures, utilities and contamination sources — only if Chart 1 cannot be met (Title 134 ch. 4 § 012.01)	Ask
Contractor registry printout and ACORD 25	The Department of Labor's search result for each trade you hire, showing its workers' compensation flag — plus the contractor's own certificate of insurance naming you as certificate holder	Free

Fees from the Application for State Electrical Inspection (rev. 3-27-26), Title 124 Appendix A (effective June 27, 2022) and § 46-606(1) and § 46-1224(3). The Division's homeowner handout still works its fee example at the pre-April-2026 rates; the form governs.

THE LOCAL DOCUMENTS — IF THEY EXIST WHERE YOU ARE

Where a city or county runs a program it issues its own paperwork under its own names, and there is no statewide vocabulary for it. These are the ones that exist nearly everywhere they exist at all. Write in what yours calls them.

What my jurisdiction calls each document

	Item	Date	Notes
☐	County zoning permit for a nonfarm building, with the plans "including sanitation, plumbing and sewage disposal": Called _____ Issued by _____		
☐	Building permit application — and whether there is a homeowner version and on what conditions: Called _____ Conditions? _____		

What my jurisdiction calls each document

	Item	Date	Notes
☐	Local electrical permit , if my city or county runs its own program instead of the state: Called _____ Issued by _____		
☐	Plumbing permit , if inside a city with a plumbing board, and whether a homeowner may hold it: Called _____ Homeowner? _____		
☐	Driveway or culvert permit : Called _____ Road authority _____		
☐	911 address application : Called _____ Issued by _____		
☐	Floodplain development permit , if in a mapped hazard area: Called _____ Administrator _____		
☐	Certificate of occupancy — ask whether the local program issues one, because no state rule requires it: Answer _____		

WHAT NEBRASKA DOES NOT HAVE

Worth knowing because owner-builders arriving from other states budget for these, and because anyone who tries to sell you one is selling something that does not exist.

Nine things that do not exist in Nebraska

	The position
A state building permit	None. Permits exist only where a city or county created them under § 71-6406(7). The state code applies without one
A general contractor license	None. The Contractor Registration Act is a \$40 registration for people who work on property "other than their own," and the Legislature disclaims any endorsement (§ 48-2102)
An owner-builder affidavit	None at state level — there is no exemption to affirm. The only owner-specific signature is the electrical homeowner verification . A local program may have its own form

Nine things that do not exist in Nebraska

	The position
A state plumber or HVAC license	None. Plumbing licenses are city licenses under city ordinances (§ 18-1901); no statewide registry exists. HVAC has no license at all; the wiring of the unit is an electrical specialty
A Nebraska Energy Code certificate	None. The code is the unamended 2018 IECC and the duty is yours (§ 81-1622). The IECC's own posted certificate (R401.3) is a code requirement, not a state form
A statewide sprinkler requirement	None — IRC R313 is excluded from the state code. A city or county may adopt it (§ 71-6406(2)(c)(iii)); check the local amendments
A state certificate of occupancy	None. Local programs may issue one; ask, because a lender may want it
A voluntary state inspection	None. Unlike some states, no Nebraska agency can be asked to inspect a private house against the building code. The electrical inspection is the only state visit
A list of counties with building permits	None. No statute requires a county to have a program or to report one. NE.4 gives you the three-question check

THE ONE THING YOU MAY NOT DO YOURSELF

Nebraska is generous about owner-performed work. You may act as your own general contractor, wire your own principal residence without a license, and drill your own well on your own homestead. **You may not install your own septic system** — and the published guides have this exactly backwards, licensing the well and loosening the septic.

The two sentences that settle it

"A private onsite wastewater treatment system shall not be sited, laid out, constructed, closed, reconstructed, altered, modified, repaired, inspected, or pumped unless the siting, layout, construction ... or pumping is **carried out or supervised by** either a certified professional ..., a professional engineer licensed in Nebraska, or a registered environmental health specialist registered in Nebraska" (§ 81-15,248(1)). There is no owner exception anywhere in the Act.

And "supervised" does not mean a phone call: "No person will engage in the siting, layout, construction ... of a private onsite wastewater system unless a Master Installer, a Journeyman Installer, a professional engineer, or a registered environmental health specialist who is responsible for such work **is physically present at the site where such work is being performed** and is supervising the work" (Title 124 ch. 9 § 004). You may run the excavator beside a Master Installer who stays on site. You may not build it alone, and the professional — not you — registers it. Civil penalty: up to \$10,000 per violation per day (§ 81-15,253).

Compare the well: "an individual may construct a water well or install and repair pumps and pumping equipment onsite on land owned by him or her and used by him or her ... as his or her place of abode"

(§ 46-1233(2)) — to the Title 134 standards, registered by you within 60 days (§ 46-602(1)).

THE LIEN PAPER — THREE DOCUMENTS TO KEEP, ONE TO DEMAND

The Construction Lien Act and the sale

Document	What it is and what to do
Notice of the right to assert a lien	Sent to you by a sub or supplier you did not contract with, carrying the statutory warning about double liability (§ 52-135). Date it on receipt; from that day, unpaid balances owed to the prime contractor may be reachable
Lien waiver	Not a statutory form; a signed release you demand from every trade and supplier with every payment. As your own general contractor, every trade contracts with you directly, and the waivers are the whole of your protection
Recorded construction lien	What a claimant records with the register of deeds within 120 days of last furnishing labor or materials (§ 52-137(1)); after that it "does not attach and may not be enforced." Check the county's records before you close a construction loan or sell
Seller disclosure statement	The written statement every seller of residential property gives (§ 76-2,120) — except on "newly constructed residential real property which has never been occupied" ((6)(k)). Once you have lived in the house, you give it, to the best of your knowledge — and you built it

As a "protected party" — an individual who has residential real estate improved which they occupy or intend to occupy (§ 52-129(1)(a)) — the notice mechanism and the payment cap in § 52-136 run in your favor. NE.1 sets them out.

Every statute cited here is free to read at one address you can type:

nebraskalegislature.gov/laws/statutes.php?statute=81-2121 — swap in any section number, comma included (81-15,248). Each page ends with a **Source** line naming every session law that touched it and, after a recent change, an **Effective Date** line. Read that line before you rely on the section. The rules are PDFs: Title 124 (septic) and Title 134 (wells) at **dwee.nebraska.gov**, the electrical Board rules at **electrical.nebraska.gov/statutes-rules**. **One warning:** the Board's rules PDF (April 2024) still calls an unfiled request for inspection a misdemeanor. Since July 18, 2026 the statute says felony. The statute wins. Read September 2026.